Case Briefing

Friday, October 16

Dear Detective,

Thank you for agreeing to look at this file. I'll be honest with you: our station has three officers, one bicycle and a kettle, and this case needs fresh eyes.

At 8:55 this morning, Priya Halloran opened Quillfeather & Co. Rare Books on the High Street and found the owner, Mr. Cornelius Quillfeather, 72, at the foot of the rolling ladder in the Rare Book Room. He fell from the top of that ladder on Thursday evening, and he never woke up.

It would be easy to call it an accident, but the brass top rung had been loosened on purpose. Its two screws had been turned out with a small screwdriver. And a valuable first edition, The Marsh Clock, is missing from the top shelf.

Five people had reason to be near that ladder this week. Their profiles are in the file, with everything PC Ashby and I gathered today: interviews, the key register, the ledger, Mr. Quillfeather's diary, a bus timetable, even the weather log.

I need three answers from you, in order. They are set out overleaf. Take your time, check everything twice, and trust paper over people.

With thanks,

Harriet Moss
Detective Inspector Harriet Moss
Little Wexham CID



You are the consulting detective. You don't play a character; you read the file, compare the papers and name the truth.

Your Three Objectives

Solve them in order. Each answer helps with the next. Write your answers on the 04 worksheets before you check them.

1 THE LIE

Objective 1 · The Lie

One suspect's account of Thursday evening is false. Name that suspect, and name the **two documents** that prove the account is false.

2 THE METHOD

Objective 2 · The Method

When was the top rung loosened (a time window on Thursday), and how did the person who did it get into the locked Rare Book Room?

3 THE CULPRIT

Objective 3 · The Culprit

Name the culprit, explain the motive, and list up to three key documents that prove it.

Rules of the case

1. Everything you need is in this file. No outside knowledge and no internet needed.
2. The case covers Thursday, October 15, to Friday, October 16. Times use the 12-hour clock.
3. Documents are numbered D1 to D18 (file 03). Suspect cards are in file 02.
4. Check an answer only after you've written it down: use **Case-Checker.html** (works offline in a modern browser) or open the matching page of **97**.
5. Stuck? Take a hint card from file 05: Hint A first, then B, then C.
6. File **99** is the full solution. Read it last, when the case is closed.

> **DI MOSS'S ADVICE**
>
> People remember things the way they wish they'd happened. Timetables, registers and receipts don't. When a statement and a document disagree, find out which one is wrong.